

higher bandwidth than the ViewSonic (250 MHz).

Maximum resolution: The maximum resolution of the monitor is the product of video bandwidth and refresh rate. The higher the video bandwidth of the monitor, the more the resolution at a higher refresh rate.

In the 15-inch category, almost all the monitors had the standard 65 MHz video bandwidth but the ViewSonic E53 had an excellent video bandwidth of 110 MHz and therefore the monitor could easily take the maximum resolution of 1280x1024 pixel at 60 Hz refresh rate and 1024x768 pixels at 75Hz, which is a very good resolution for a 15-inch monitor. The other monitor that could work at resolution as high as 1280x1024 pixels at 60 Hz was Sony CPD-E100.

All the other monitors managed 1024x768 pixels but because of the lower refresh rate it became very uncomfortable to work at that resolution due to the high amount of flicker.

Dot pitch: Dot pitch is the distance measured between two like-coloured phosphor dots—that is, if the distance between two red coloured dots is, say 0.25 mm, then the dot pitch of the monitor is 0.25 mm. A low

dot pitch means that the display will be sharp and crisp.

Most good quality monitors have a dot pitch as low as 0.20 mm and you can see this in the Samsung SyncMaster 955DF. Even 15-inch monitors such as the Sony CPD-E100 and Samsung 55E have the diagonal dot pitch as low as 0.24 mm whereas it is 0.28 mm generally.

In the 19-inch category, HP P920 and Samsung SyncMaster 900IFT had a dot pitch of 0.24 mm. In the 21-inch category, ViewSonic G810 had a dot pitch as low as 0.22 mm and this is particularly good for a 21-inch monitor because at higher resolution and a dot pitch as small as 0.22 mm, the image will appear extremely crisp and sharp on the screen, making it a joy to work with image-editing software or watch movies, especially on DVD.

Dimensions: An important consideration, especially if you are tight on space, is the dimension of the monitor. If the monitor ends up taking up all the space on the table, then you better start practising typing with the keyboard on your lap. The depth and width are more of a concern than the height and therefore monitors with less depth and width are considered space savers.



The one monitor that comes to mind while talking about the dimension, especially the depth, is the Philips 105E which had a depth of 379 mm.

In the 19-inch category, the monitor that had the smallest depth was the Samsung SyncMaster 900NF (only 460 mm).

If you are very finicky about dirt and like to experiment with the position of your monitor, then you better consider the weight factor also, as you might have to move the monitor around when cleaning. Preferably, keep your 21-inch or 19-inch in a place where you don't have to move it too much and there's enough space at the back too if you have to adjust the monitor cables—especially if you happen to have the Acer P911, which is the heaviest at 28.2 Kg (even heavier than the 27-kg, 21-inch ViewSonic). The Philips 105E forms the other end of the spectrum, being the lightest at 11.5 kg.